

AI in your **Exact Online** administration

What an AI assistant on the books can do today, where the limits are and how to start safely. Written for controllers and CFOs.

IN SHORT

- MCP makes AI assistants usable on your administration: answers come from Exact Online per question, not from a language model's memory.
- Claire answers questions about your figures, prepares the month-end close, watches receivables and runs schedules.
- Reading is free, writing only after your approval. No shadow copy of your data, access per user, every action logged.
- Starting small is fine: from €99 per month, live within a day, cancel monthly.

WHO THIS IS FOR

For controllers, CFOs and accountants who work with Exact Online and want to judge whether an AI assistant on the administration is something for their team. No AI background needed; where technology comes up, we explain it.

CONTENTS

1	What MCP is and why it matters for finance	3
2	Four tasks Claire takes over today	5
3	Security and control	7
4	What it costs	9
5	Getting started	10
·	About DataFlowr	11

What MCP is and why it matters for finance

MCP stands for Model Context Protocol, an open standard introduced by Anthropic in late 2024 and now broadly adopted. It describes how an AI assistant may use a system's tools: which actions exist, which data they involve and how access is arranged. What USB-C is for accessories, MCP is for AI connections: one plug that fits every assistant.

How it works

A system, say your accounting package, offers an MCP server: a list of well-defined tools such as "fetch the trial balance" or "show this customer's outstanding items". Per question the assistant picks the tool it needs, calls it and phrases the answer based on what comes back.

Crucially, the model does not get a copy of your database. Every question triggers a targeted query in the administration itself, at the moment you ask it. There is no data dump living its own life somewhere else.

The AI assistant does not get an export of your administration, it gets a doorbell. Every question passes through your authorisation, and the figures stay where they are.

Why this matters for finance

For a marketing text it hardly matters where an answer comes from. For a balance sheet position it does. Three properties make the difference between a chatbot and a verifiable answer:

1. **Answers come from the administration, not from the model.** The language model phrases; the figures are fetched per question through a tool. That makes it traceable which query underlies an answer, and that is exactly what a controller wants to be able to verify.
2. **Authorisation stays where it belongs.** Access runs through your existing login and permissions. No separate copy, no shared export folder, no service account with overly broad rights.
3. **You are not tied to one assistant.** Because MCP is an open standard, the same connection works in Claude, in other MCP clients and in your own agents. The investment is in the connection to your administration, not in one vendor's chatbot.

Works in the assistant you already use

The same connection works in Claude, ChatGPT and Microsoft Copilot, and as a building block in Make, n8n and Zapier. You can switch assistants at any time; what you build up is not lost.

Four tasks Claire takes over today

Claire is DataFlowr's AI colleague, built on an MCP server for Exact Online. She opens up nearly every part of the administration, in the chat and autonomously on a schedule. Four tasks where that saves work right away.

1 · Questions about your figures

Ask the question the way you would ask a colleague: "show the profit and loss against last year", "how is our cash runway doing", "which items are about to run out of stock". Claire fetches the current figures straight from Exact Online and answers as text, a table or an overview card, traceable down to the ledger.

2 · Preparing the month-end close

The close is where control and time pressure collide. Claire runs a fixed set of deterministic checks on your books, investigates anomalies and delivers a close-readiness report with findings and recommendations.

01 · FIXED

Check

A fixed set of close checks runs on your books.

02 · ANALYSIS

Investigate

Anomalies are investigated and entries scanned for items that need a judgement.

03 · REPORT

Report

You get a close-readiness report with findings and recommendations.

04 · YOU DECIDE

Review

You review each finding; corrections only happen after your approval.

3 · Watching receivables

Claire watches outstanding items, builds ageing analyses and prepares reminders, or sends them on schedule. Nothing goes out the door without your approval.

INVOICE	CUSTOMER	AMOUNT	DAYS
VK-2026-214	Acme Group	€22,480	18
VK-2026-198	Helder BV	€8,950	34
VK-2026-167	Van Dijk Techniek	€18,200	94

14 invoices open, €48,200 in total. Reminders prepared. Example from our demo environment; amounts and names are fictitious.

4 · Schedules: work that comes back on its own

An agent runs work on a schedule: close checks on the first working day, a weekly receivables overview, a cash flow forecast in your inbox every Monday. You only hear from it when it needs you.

Three ways to put Claire to work

1. **Interactive.** Open your AI assistant and ask a question about your books in plain language.
2. **Autonomous.** An agent runs work on a schedule and only reports back when it needs you.
3. **Integrated.** Use the connector in Make, n8n or Zapier as a building block in your automations.

Security and control

The question every controller asks: what can such an assistant do, and who keeps that in check? The way Claire is set up gives a verifiable answer.

Read freely, write on approval

Claire reads and calculates on her own, but never writes unprompted: every change waits as a proposal for your explicit approval. If you do not approve a proposal, nothing happens and the proposal stays ready.

Access per user

Everyone connects with their own Exact Online account, through the official APIs and secure OAuth, and can do exactly what they may there, nothing more. Every action is logged under their name, so afterwards you can see who asked what and what happened.

No shadow copy

Your data stays in Exact Online. Claire fetches only what a given answer needs; no copy of your books ends up in an external platform.

Calculation outside the language model

The calculation work does not happen in the language model but in a calculation layer that is deterministic and traceable. The language model only phrases the answer; the figures come from your own administration, and every answer shows its source data.

A managed product, not loose scripts

Claire runs in an environment DataFlowr develops and manages. Changes to the Exact Online API and new features are our job, not yours: centrally managed, with a stable interface.

Where the limits are

Claire replaces neither a bookkeeper nor judgement. She prepares, flags and substantiates; deciding remains human work. Answers are as good as the administration itself: what is not in there, Claire cannot know. And because writing always passes through your approval, you set the pace at which you trust her with more.

How we handle data is in the privacy policy: dataflowr.nl/en/privacy.

What it costs

Every plan runs on your own Exact Online and can be cancelled monthly.

PLAN	PER MONTH	ADMINISTRATIONS	INCLUDED
Individual	€99	3	Standard support
Business	€299	5	Guided onboarding
Firm	€749	Unlimited	Priority support + training
Enterprise	On quote	Unlimited	Custom, by agreement

Prices excl. VAT, as of August 2026; current prices at dataflowr.nl/en/claire.

Standard support means working from the documentation at dataflowr.nl/en/docs; Business and Firm add guidance and training. Individual is ample room for one user's day-to-day questions; Business and Firm mainly stretch the usage volume for teams.

Getting started

No implementation project and no migration: the connection uses the administration as it stands. If you want to, you are live within a day.

STEP 1

Connect

Click “Connect Exact Online” on dataflowr.nl/en/claire. Registration happens along the way, in the same step.

STEP 2

Sign in

Your account keeps the connection and your conversations; after signing in you land right back where you were.

STEP 3

Approve

You approve the connection in Exact Online itself, with secure OAuth. Ready in about 2 minutes.

STEP 4

First question

Claire looks into your administration and you ask your first question, in Claude, ChatGPT or Copilot.

The first week

- Ask for the outstanding sales invoices, sorted by age.
- Run the close checks for last month.
- Turn on one schedule, for example a weekly receivables overview.
- Invite a colleague; everyone connects with their own account.

Prefer to walk through it together? Book a 30-minute intro via dataflowr.nl/en/contact and we set it up with you.

DataFlowr

DataFlowr is a specialised Exact Online Premium integration partner and hyperautomation consultancy, founded in 2025 by Daan Jansen (financial control and consultancy) and Jan-Willem Gmelig Meyling (solution architect and software engineer). Knowledge of the Exact Online ecosystem, finance processes and software engineering sits in one team.

Besides Claire we build integrations, workflow orchestration and RPA, and we train finance teams on their own administration. The knowledge base at dataflowr.nl/en/resources shows what that looks like in practice, including the articles this whitepaper draws on.



dataflowr.nl · info@dataflowr.nl · +31 23 2052813 · linkedin.com/company/dataflowr

DataFlowr B.V. · Chamber of Commerce (KVK) 99021145 · Van Marsbergenstraat 71, 2134 LV Hoofddorp, the Netherlands



dataflowr.nl

© 2026 DataFlowr · Claire, the AI layer on top of Exact Online